CHAPTER 11

The Production Landscape

Docker, and more generally, containerization establishes a new paradigm for packaging, running, and coordinating pieces of software. It's no surprise that this has a major impact on the way we deliver and manage software running in production. If you're inexperienced with operations, particularly now that Docker is in the mix, this world can feel like a maze. So, before we get our hands dirty with preparing to deploy our app in a production-like environment, we first need to familiarize ourselves with the lay of the land.

In this chapter, we'll start with a refresher on what it means to deliver and run software in production. Next, we'll explore how Docker shifts that landscape, and what delivery looks like if you embrace Docker. We'll cover the various hosting options, the tools you'll encounter (and their purpose), and the trade-offs you'll need to consider when choosing what you'll use for your production environment.

This chapter is unique in that it's purely informational: there are no practical steps to follow along with. So put your feet up, relax for a moment, and enjoy the change of pace.

The "Ops" in DevOps

Our focus as software developers is often on the development phase, with its discovery, analysis, testing, and building activities.

Depending on your work environment, you may or may not be heavily involved in operations—or just *Ops*—which involves delivering and running software in production. We can break this down into a number of different areas:

1. Provisioning
2. Configuration management
3. Release management